



levelUp

A COLLECTION OF PRO TIPS FOR EVERYTHING. Without being limited to a particular topic, these tips are from popular software, to coding, to browsers, search, storage rules, password rules, mobile device hacks, bios cracking, tweaks explained and everything tech under the sun.

How to optimise airflow in your PC cabinet

Figuring out the best airflow for your PC cabinet can be confusing. Here's a handy guide to help you achieve optimal airflow inside

Abhijit Dey | abhijit@digit.in

BUILDING A PC is a therapeutic process for most of us at Digit. Spending hours on figuring out the most suitable routes for all the cables is quite normal. Implementing the best cable management is of priority. However, not at the cost of lower cooling performance. Air cooling is the most basic and easiest method to keep your system cool. It is also capable enough to handle basic overclocking. Your PC cabinet will consist of several locations to install cooling fans. Your objective is to ensure that the cabinet has a balanced flow of hot and cool air. If you mess up this balance, you will face problems gradually.

We all know that overheating components is bad news. Populating each and every fan mount with high-speed fans won't really achieve the best cooling performance. By keeping a few things in mind, you can actually extend the lifespan of

your PC components. Here's our guide to achieve optimal airflow in your cabinet.



PC CABINET LAYOUT

The internal design of PC cabinets often keeps changing for the better. Not very long ago, the interiors looked like a

claustrophobic person's worst nightmare. Optical drives and hard drive bays usually took up almost half of the space inside. This design immensely affected airflow since the drive cages restricted a lot of air intake from the front fans. Power supply units used to be installed on the top-rear of the cabinets. Since hot air rises, it was a bad design choice. Next came the painful task of cable

management. If you've dealt with the ketchup-and-mustard mess of cables from non-modular PSUs, you'd understand. Earlier, cable management was accomplished with just the motherboard plate cut-outs. The entangled cables inside the cabinet would end up obstructing the airflow to an extent. Also, they would straight up look messy if your cabinet had a transparent windowed side panel. These designs still exist in cabinets on the lower price range.

For the past few years, this has changed. Optical drives aren't found anymore in the majority of the cabinets nowadays. The number of hard drive bays have also reduced over time. This has opened up more room (literally) for additional fans to be installed on the front panel. The power supply is nowadays mostly mounted on the bottom-rear. So now you can add another fan below the top panel. Apart from compact cabinets, you will also find fan mounts on the bottom. However, this isn't new. New design



Cable management was difficult earlier, so was optimal air cooling.